



Egyptian acacia

This flowering tree grows widely in Egypt. In ancient times, the wood from it was used to make boats and furniture.

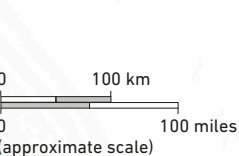


Diving in the Red Sea

Divers flock to the Red Sea to enjoy the underwater world of shipwrecks, corals, and thriving marine life—including oceanic whitetip sharks!

Lantern displays

During the Islamic holy month of Ramadan, colorful lanterns called fanous are put up in homes and public places across Egypt.



Mysterious tombs

One of the Seven Wonders of the World, the Pyramids of Giza in Cairo are more than 4,500 years old. They were built as giant tombs for ancient Egyptian pharaohs (rulers).

The largest of the pyramids is made from 2.3 million stone blocks.

Shipping shortcut

The Suez Canal is a 120-mile (193-km) waterway that connects the Mediterranean Sea to the Red Sea. Built by the French in the 1860s to allow a direct route between Europe and Asia, it is now owned by Egypt.



Geography: Egypt consists of vast swaths of **desert**, green **river valleys**, **mountains**, and **Red Sea** and **Mediterranean coastline**.



History: Egypt's **ancient civilization** lasted for around **3,000 years**. From the mid-600s, Egypt was ruled by **Muslim Arabs**.



Culture: Everyday life is largely centered on the **family** and **Muslim traditions**. Egypt also has a thriving **media and arts scene**.



Natural wonders: The **Nile** is the **world's longest river**—it flows over a distance of **more than 4,100 miles (6,600 km)**.



Wildlife: **Jackals**, **fennec foxes**, and **scorpions** are desert dwellers. **Vipers** and **cobras** are sometimes seen in the Nile Valley.



Food and drink: Egyptian cuisine blends **spices**, **lentils**, and **rice** to make a variety of dishes often served with **minced** or **grilled lamb**.